

YOUR VALUES. YOUR WORDS. YOUR PACE.

VALUES-BASED AI RELATIONSHIP ONBOARDING

A starting guide for how your AI should communicate and think alongside you.

A one-hour facilitated conversation. No prior AI experience needed.

BEFORE WE MEET

Look through these nine questions so you know what we will explore. You may write, sketch, combine options, or leave a question blank. Preparation is optional.

Bring the pages you choose to share. We can use photos of your written answers or talk through the questions together.

DURING OUR CONVERSATION

We will reflect your answers, suggest possible settings, and let you correct them before they become part of your guide.

THINK AHEAD · TALK TOGETHER · REVIEW YOUR GUIDE

GETTING ORIENTED

THREE SEPARATE LAYERS

1 / RELATIONSHIP SETTINGS

How your AI communicates, explains, asks questions, challenges, repairs misunderstandings, and respects your control.

2 / OPTIONAL PERSONAL CONTEXT

A separate reference with background you approve, why it matters, and when it may be used. Facts do not automatically become rules.

3 / PRIVATE PROJECT WORK

Your tasks, notebook, and first projects stay separate. The facilitator does not need access.

AI can be useful and can also misunderstand or be wrong. You remain the decision-maker.

You do not need to share household, family, health, work, or financial details to complete this onboarding.

BEFORE QUESTION 1

YOUR BOUNDARIES

We are creating a starting guide for how your AI should communicate and think alongside you. We are not planning projects today, and you do not need to share household, family, health, work, or financial details.

AI can help explain unfamiliar subjects, organize information, compare possibilities, notice patterns, and create starting points. It can also misunderstand you and give incorrect information. You remain the decision-maker.

I will ask one question at a time. You may skip a question, combine options, answer in your own words, or keep something out of the final document. After each answer, I will reflect what I heard so you can correct it.

Before we begin, is there anything you want to keep outside this conversation or the final settings document?

You may name a boundary without explaining the private material.

Question 1 of 9

TONE AND RELATIONSHIP

What would you like it to feel like when you sit down to work with your AI?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Warm and encouraging
2. Calm and grounded
3. Direct and efficient
4. Playful and energetic
5. Curious and collaborative
6. Formal and professional
7. A hybrid
8. Something in your own words

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 2 of 9

TRUST AND DISENGAGEMENT

What kinds of AI responses would make you tune out, become frustrated, or stop trusting the conversation?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Information that is untrue or not checked
2. Assumptions presented as facts
3. Inflated praise, hype, or excessive reassurance
4. Dense or visually unbroken answers
5. Too many questions at once
6. Agreement that feels placating rather than reasoned
7. Excessive jargon or unexplained abbreviations
8. A hybrid
9. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 3 of 9

LEARNING AND UNDERSTANDING

When you encounter a completely unfamiliar subject, what helps it begin to make sense?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. A visual model
2. The larger pattern or system
3. A vocabulary key
4. A concrete example
5. A comparison or analogy
6. Practical steps
7. Trying something with guidance
8. A hybrid
9. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 4 of 9

EMERGING THOUGHTS AND IDEAS

When your own thought or idea is still unfinished, what should the AI do first?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Briefly reflect the pattern it thinks it sees
2. Ask one clarifying question
3. Organize the pieces into a possible structure
4. Offer several possible interpretations
5. Create a rough starting point to react to
6. Wait while you continue thinking aloud
7. A hybrid
8. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 5 of 9

HOW THE AI SHOULD ASK QUESTIONS

How should the AI ask you questions?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Ask one direct question at a time
2. Briefly explain why the answer matters
3. Provide several numbered answer possibilities
4. Always allow a hybrid or an answer in the client's own words
5. Make a reasonable first attempt before asking
6. Gather several questions together
7. Ask only when the missing information would materially change the result
8. A hybrid
9. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 6 of 9

VALUES UNDERNEATH THE RELATIONSHIP

What should the AI protect or respect across everything you do together?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Truth and accuracy
2. Agency and authorship
3. Privacy and dignity
4. Creativity and curiosity
5. Relationships and community
6. Impact on other people
7. Accessibility and present capacity
8. Time or financial care
9. A hybrid
10. Something entirely their own

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 6 / a closer look

VALUES UNDERNEATH THE RELATIONSHIP

What should never be traded away merely to make something faster, easier, or more efficient?

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 6 / a closer look

WHEN VALUES CONFLICT

If values conflict, how should the AI respond?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Pause and surface the conflict before recommending anything
2. Offer several paths and their tradeoffs
3. Make a provisional recommendation and explain the conflict
4. Ask which value leads in this situation
5. A hybrid
6. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 7 of 9

CHALLENGE AND DISAGREEMENT

When should the AI challenge your thinking?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. When a factual claim appears unsupported or incorrect
2. When the direction conflicts with a value or boundary the client named
3. When an affected person or important perspective may be missing
4. When two parts of the reasoning contradict each other
5. When a plan appears impractical or carries meaningful risk
6. Only when the client asks for critique
7. Any of these when relevant to the situation
8. A hybrid
9. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 7 / a closer look

HOW TO DELIVER A CHALLENGE

How should the challenge be delivered?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Evidence first - state the concern and strongest support directly
2. Question first - ask whether the client has considered it
3. Brief flag - name the concern and ask whether analysis is wanted
4. Hybrid - briefly name it, give the strongest evidence, and let the client choose whether to explore it
5. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 8 of 9

MISUNDERSTANDING AND REPAIR

When the AI misunderstands what you mean, what should it do first?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Reflect what it thought the client meant and ask where it diverged
2. Ask one focused question before trying again
3. Offer two or three possible interpretations
4. Correct immediately using the new information
5. Briefly identify the likely misunderstanding, offer interpretations when useful, ask one focused question, and then correct the work
6. Something else

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

Question 9 of 9

HUMAN CONTROL AND PERMISSION

What should remain in your hands unless you explicitly decide otherwise?

If examples help, choose, combine, or use your own words.

1. Final decisions
2. Creative authorship
3. External messages, posts, publication, or sharing
4. Files, accounts, purchases, or other consequential actions
5. Personal information and what may be remembered or reused
6. All of the above, with boundaries changed only when explicitly requested
7. A different combination or rule

Your own words, a hybrid, or a thought to return to:

Optional notes · You may skip or keep this answer private.

OPTIONAL / AFTER THE NINE QUESTIONS

BACKGROUND & LIVED EXPERTISE

This separate pass is your choice. You may describe relevant knowledge or experience without naming other people or sharing private details.

What knowledge, relationships, communities, or life experiences have shaped how you think, even when they do not appear as your own job title or formal education?

You choose whether a detail belongs in your settings, a separate context profile, or neither.

OPTIONAL / REVIEWING AN INTERPRETATION

WHAT THE DETAIL MEANS

If you choose to provide background, we will distinguish the factual detail from what it might mean for how AI works with you.

I noticed [factual detail]. It may suggest [possible relevance or AI behavior]. How should I treat it?

1. Accurate - include the behavioral implication in my AI settings
2. Accurate but contextual - keep it in my personal context profile
3. Partly accurate - revise it with me
4. True but private - do not include or repeat it
5. Not relevant to how AI should work with me
6. Incorrect - remove it

We will confirm what may be used or repeated. Someone else's credentials, status, or access do not become yours by association.

FINAL READ-BACK

REVIEW BY SECTION

We will read back concise candidate settings, one section at a time.

1. Tone and engagement
2. Truth and trust
3. Thinking and learning
4. Questions and presentation
5. Values underneath the work
6. Challenge and disagreement
7. Misunderstanding and repair
8. Agency, boundaries, and permission
9. Shared language, if any

These are starting settings. They may be contextual, provisional, or revised through real use.

FINAL READ-BACK / YOUR CHOICE

DOES THIS SOUND LIKE YOU?

1. Yes - keep it
2. Mostly - revise part of it
3. It depends - name the context
4. Keep it as something we are trying, not a settled rule
5. Keep it private
6. Remove it

Use these choices for each section of the guide.

BEFORE FINALIZING / 1

ONE FINAL CHECK

Is anything here too strong, too permanent, or based on an assumption you did not make?

BEFORE FINALIZING / 2

ANYTHING STILL MISSING?

Is there anything important about beginning this AI relationship that the guide still does not understand?

YOUR NEXT STEP

TAKE YOUR GUIDE WITH YOU

YOUR APPROVED RELATIONSHIP SETTINGS

A short Working With Me guide, in language you have reviewed. Place it in your chosen AI's settings when you are ready.

YOUR OPTIONAL PERSONAL CONTEXT

Keep this in a separate file under your control. Include only approved details and their handling boundaries.

YOUR PRIVATE PROJECT WORK

You may complete a private reflection notebook, create a brief for your first project, and use the AI without the facilitator present.

Return later with only the setting you want to revise. You do not need to disclose the private project.

A beginning relationship guide, ready to learn from real use.